Call Your Bill Companies — What to Say

A simple tool from Southern Oak Financial & Wellness. Keep this sheet by your phone.

BEFORE YOU CALL

Have these ready: your bill, your account number, and a pen and paper. Call in the morning on a weekday if you can — the lines are shorter. Be calm and polite. The person on the phone did not set the price, but they often CAN lower it.

THE WORDS TO SAY (works for most bills)

> *"Hi, my name is ____. I have been a customer for ____, and I pay my bill on time. Right now this bill is hard for my family. Is there a lower plan, a discount, or a special offer I can get?"*

If they say no, ask:

> *"Can I speak with the loyalty or retention team? They may have offers you cannot see."*
>
> *"Do you have a hardship plan or a payment plan that lowers what I pay each month?"*

BILL BY BILL

Phone and internet: Ask about a lower plan or a loyalty discount. Ask if a smaller plan still covers what you use.

Electric and gas: Ask about "budget billing" — the same amount every month, so there are no surprise high bills.

Medical bills: Ask for an itemized bill (every charge listed). Check it. Then ask for a payment plan — many hospitals will take small monthly payments with no interest.

Credit cards: Ask for a hardship program or a lower interest rate while you pay the card down.

Insurance: Ask them to re-check your price, and ask what discounts you are missing (safe driver, home + auto together, paperless).

WRITE IT DOWN

For every call, write: the date, the name of the person, and what they promised. If the price does not change on your next bill, call back with your notes.

One last thing: you never need to pay a company to make these calls for you. This sheet and your own voice are enough.

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